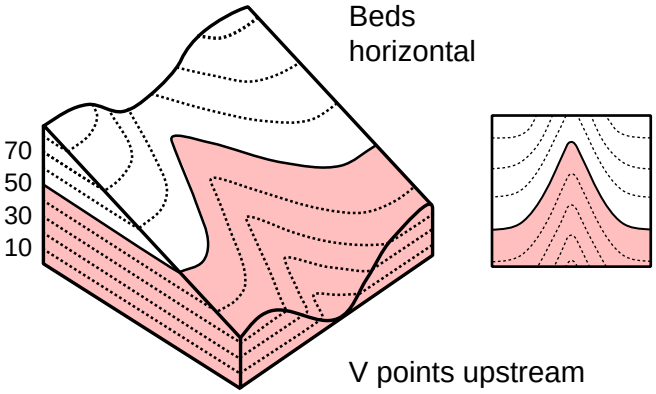
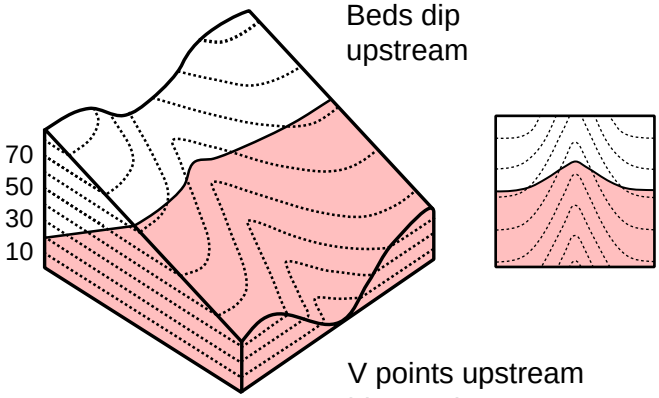
V-SHAPED OUTCROP PATTERNS

A uniformly dipping surface which crops out across a valley can give rise to a V-shaped outcrop pattern in which the V points either upstream or downstream. The direction and sharpness of the V depends upon the dip of the surface and so its shape is useful for establishing approximately what this dip is



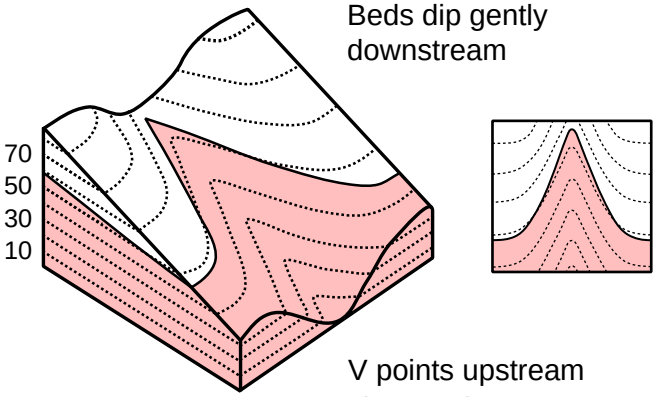
Beds horizontal

V points upstream parallel to contours



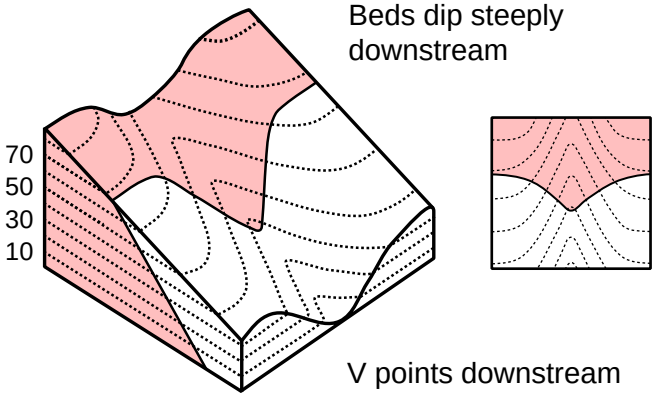
Beds dip upstream

V points upstream blunter than contours



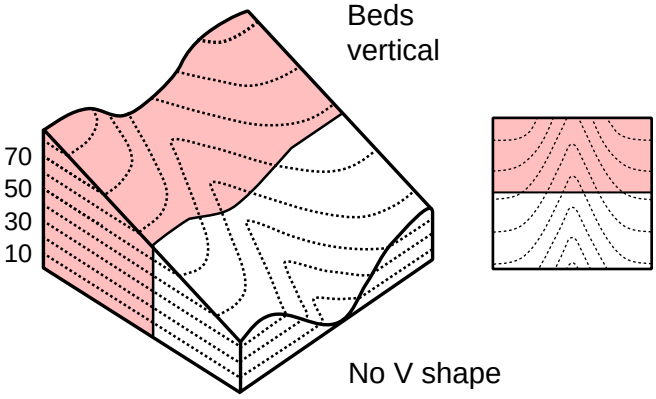
Beds dip gently downstream

V points upstream sharper than contours



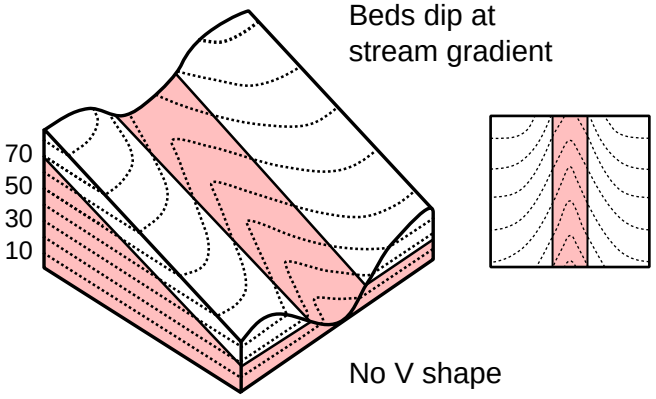
Beds dip steeply downstream

V points downstream



Beds vertical

No V shape



Beds dip at stream gradient

No V shape